

**Solution-focused, not political.** We're all Philadelphians solving a problem together.

**The problem is in the system, not individuals.** No blame, no shame. The system was designed for a different economy.

**Shepherd mindset.** Shepherds focus on solutions with love. Be the shepherd when advocating for LIFT. In the room with us? Share your fear, uncertainty, and doubt—we'll help you through it.

## The Problem

For 10 years, Philadelphia's smallest businesses had a shield from BIRT (Business Income and Receipts Tax)—letting them start, grow, and support their families. **In 2026, that shield is gone.**

If in **2025** you earned **\$50,000** and you are a:

Laborer (Independent Contractor)

Individual Enterprise

Family Enterprise

Starting in April 2026, your Philadelphia tax bill will increase by:

**+\$1,208 ————— +\$3,746**

That's between 1 and 3 months' rent for many Philadelphians who simply can't afford it.



Calculate Yours Instantly

[liftphilly.org/calculator](https://liftphilly.org/calculator)

**85%**

of all city businesses

That includes 122,000 Philadelphians who own and operate single-owner entities: contractors, freelancers, gig workers, nurses, barbers, food truck vendors, artists, retailers, and more.

## The Solution: The LIFT Act

Pioneering legislation introduced in November 2025 by Councilman Mike Driscoll, the LIFT Act fixes the system instead of patching it by acknowledging a **tax class that already exists** but is unrecognized by current BIRT law.

This class includes Laborers/Independent Contractors, and any individual or family enterprises with an individual owner (including those with employees).



Meets PA Constitution's Uniformity Clause requirements.

### What the LIFT Act Enables

- ✓ City Council and the Mayor can legally remove BIRT for the LIFT class\* completely
- ✓ NPT tax remains, ensuring fair taxation instead of the current double-taxation structure
- ✓ Keeps money in local neighborhoods—every dollar retained turns into \$3+ in local spending

**Result for an individual or family earning \$50K: completely eliminates the surprise tax increase**

***\*LIFT class includes Laborers (Independent Contractors), and any individual or family enterprises with an individual owner (including those with employees).***

This resource is not intended to be legal advice and your legal and tax advisors should be consulted.

The LIFT class does not include S-Corp and C-Corp entities.

### 1 Calculate Your Increase Before Filing

Use the calculator at [liftphilly.org/calculator](https://liftphilly.org/calculator) to see your tax increase, then share it with your professional network so they can calculate theirs.



Calculate Yours Instantly  
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### 2 Start Conversations

Ask 3-5 solopreneurs you know:

*"If you had to pay 1-3 months extra rent in taxes in 2026 and beyond, how would that affect your ability to care for yourself, your family, and your community?"*

Then listen. Report back what you hear.

### 3 Help Us Reach the Whole City

Share this information with your friends & trusted community leaders, and help us grow our network of networks.

Know someone who can help spread the word through your community, share their experiences as a small business owner, or both? We're looking for both formal leaders and informal connectors.

### 4 Identify Testimony Voices

We're building a coalition that reflects all of Philadelphia—every zip code, every background, every identity. Help us find powerful voices from:

- Arts & Culture
- Barbers & Hair Stylists
- Business Associations & Districts
- Childcare providers
- Community Health/Orgs
- Construction/trades
- Creative (music, film, photo)
- Education & Tutoring
- Events & Tourism
- Finance & Money
- Fitness & Wellness
- Food/hospitality
- Healthcare
- Home Services
- Legal solo practitioners
- Media & Journalism
- Pet Services
- Professional Services
- Real Estate & Development
- Reentry entrepreneurs
- Style & Fashion
- Tech & Innovation
- Transportation/rideshare
- **and your industry or category, too!**

### Bill Status and Expected Timeline

- Bill introduced November 20, 2025 by Councilman Mike Driscoll
- Council President drafted bill and provided technical support for Fiscal Analysis
- Multiple council members engaged
- Finance Committee hearings expected: Late January / Early February 2026



Join the Coalition  
[liftphilly.org](https://liftphilly.org)

Take this sheet. Try the conversation. Calculate your impact. Join the coalition.

[contact@liftphilly.org](mailto:contact@liftphilly.org)

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